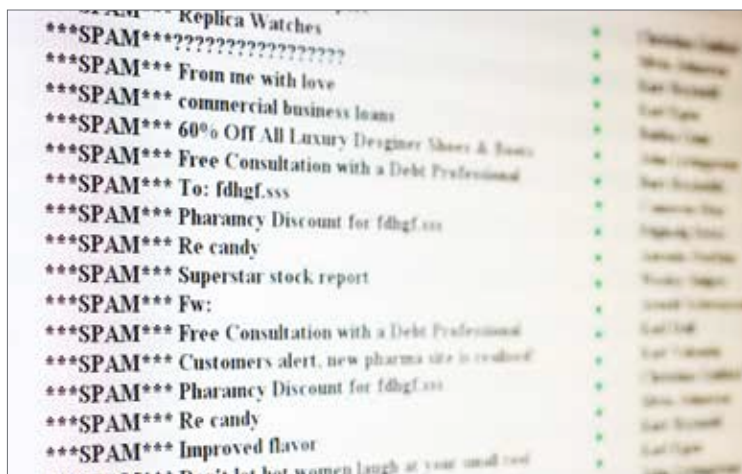




An increase in the number of keywords doesn't necessarily work in the long run.

locate text behind an image, position text off-screen, decrease font size so it is practically invisible. For someone with a working knowledge of HTML, a common way is to enclose everything within <div>, and then select Dev style to “display: none”. All this and more can either be accidentally or purposely done to improve your search ranking. However, this can very easily be found out.

5) Cloaking

This is a much more sophisticated way to ‘hide’ your website. It is also against the Webmaster Guidelines because it shows different content to the search engine and the user. For example, to the search engine it could show that it is a text rich website, while to the user it shows a flash rich website. A suitable tale of caution is that Google banned its own Google AdWords back in 2010 once it found that AdWords was cloaking.

Apart from these common don’ts, there are others that the Google Webmaster Manual warns us about. Practices such as sneakily redirecting a webpage, adding keywords that are irrelevant, sending automated queries to Google, phishing, installing malicious software like Trojans et al. Even having an excessive number of ads ala sites that host screenshots will get you in trouble. All in all, there are numerous white hat practices that can be used efficiently to speedily improve your search ranking and you should stick to them if you don’t want to get into trouble. **d**